

Comprehensive Empathy Map Canvas: Core Stakeholder Personas

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Project: Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Milestone: M1 (Phase 1 — Ideation Deliverables)

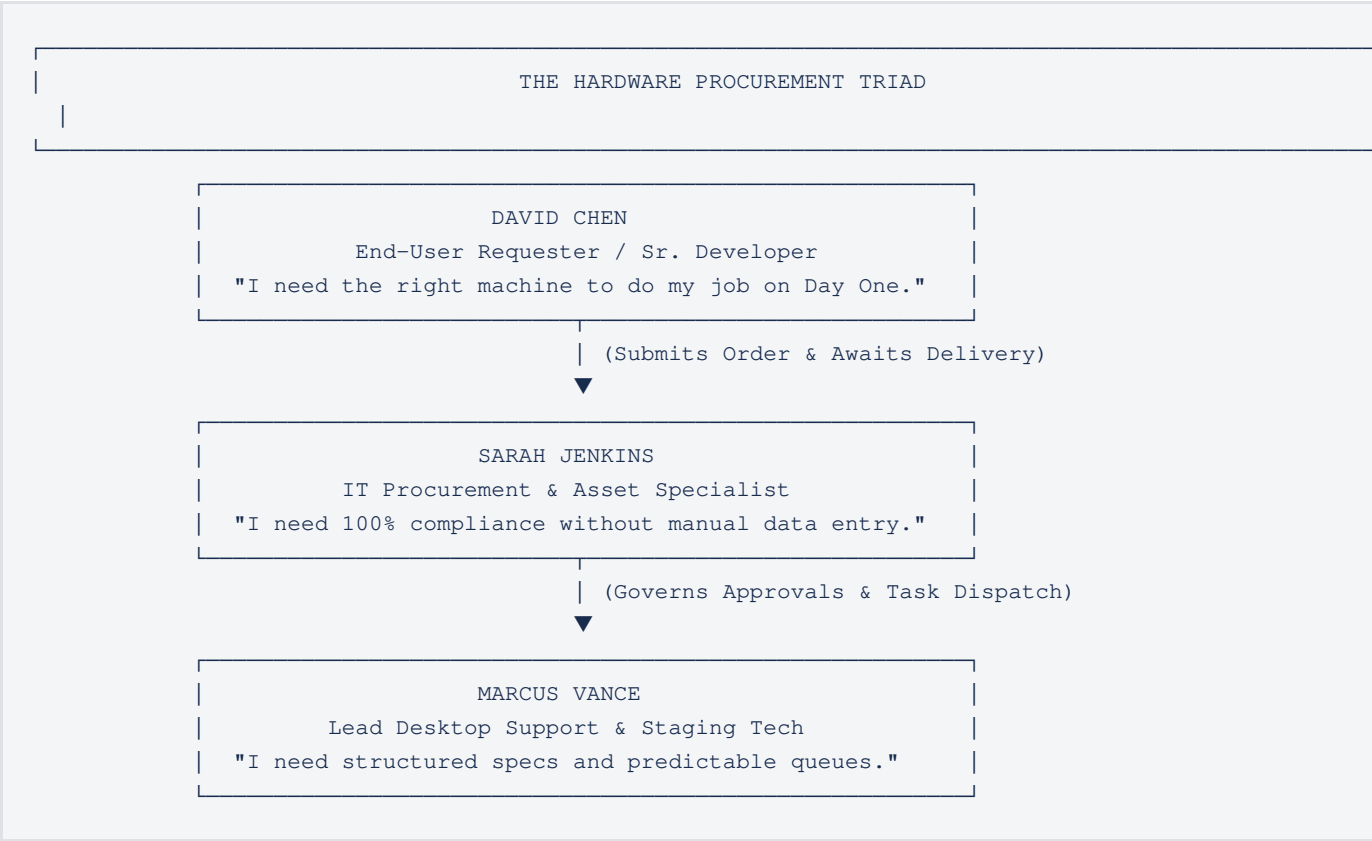
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Status: Submission Ready

1. Executive Summary & Persona Mapping Methodology

Enterprise IT transformations often fail when automation is designed strictly around database schemas rather than the real-world operational experiences, frustrations, and behavioral patterns of the human beings who interact with the system. To ensure that the **ServiceNow Flow Designer Standard Laptop Procurement Automation** delivers authentic operational relief, user satisfaction, and frictionless compliance, a rigorous Human-Centered Design (HCD) study was conducted across three pivotal stakeholder personas.



The study examined three distinct operational perspectives:

- The Fulfillment Orchestrator: Sarah Jenkins**, Senior IT Asset & Procurement Coordinator, representing

back-office operations, vendor management, and asset compliance.

- 2. **The End-User Consumer: David Chen**, Senior Full-Stack Software Engineer (and incoming new hire/refresh requester), representing technical knowledge workers requiring high-performance computing tools.
- 3. **The Hardware Configurator: Marcus Vance**, Lead Desktop Support & Hardware Staging Technician, representing depot engineering, physical configuration, imaging, and logistics.

For each persona, a deep-dive empathy canvas was synthesized encompassing full demographic context, verbatim statements (**Says**), internal cognitive processes (**Thinks**), observable behavioral habits (**Does**), emotional state dynamics (**Feels**), systemic operational friction (**Pains**), and high-value target outcomes (**Gains**).

2. Persona 1: IT Procurement Specialist — Sarah Jenkins

PERSONA PROFILE: SARAH JENKINS	
Professional Role	Senior IT Asset & Procurement Coordinator
Department	Corporate IT Operations / Procurement & Vendor Management
Demographics	Age 34, 7 years in corporate IT asset management; ITIL v4 Managing Professional
Core Environment	ServiceNow ITSM, SAP ERP, Excel Workbooks, Dell Premier, CDW, Teams, Outlook
Core Objectives	Ensure hardware compliance, minimize holding costs, eliminate audit gaps
Performance KPIs	Procurement cycle time, inventory accuracy, asset attribution rate, audit pass

2.1. Persona Context & Behavioral Profile

Sarah Jenkins is the operational linchpin connecting corporate finance, vendor supply chains, and IT operations. She is responsible for reviewing hardware requisitions, ensuring line-manager authorizations conform to corporate delegated authorities, issuing purchase orders when depot stock is depleted, and ensuring every deployed machine is registered in ServiceNow ITAM (**alm_hardware**).

In the legacy manual environment, Sarah spends over 60% of her working day acting as a human router and data transcription clerk. Instead of focusing on vendor volume discounting or software license harvesting, she is trapped under an avalanche of unformatted emails, conflicting spreadsheets, and angry messages from hiring managers.

2.2. Sarah's Empathy Map Canvas

EMPATHY MAP CANVAS: SARAH JENKINS	
SAYS (External Communication & Direct Quotes) Concerns	THINKS (Internal Monologue & Unspoken)

"I spend half my day tracking down managers like on Teams just to get a one-word email approval." Excel?" "Every quarter, the external auditors ask for spend approval trails, and I have to dig through performance review archived Outlook PST files to prove signoff." broken." "If requesters don't specify their office site an IT or cost center, I can't place the order." "We have laptops sitting in depot shelves while that's \$3,000 people are screaming that they don't have one." thin air."	"Why are we using an enterprise platform ServiceNow if I have to copy data into Excel?" "An audit finding for unapproved hardware is going to land squarely on my even though it's the process that is "I feel like a clerical typist instead of procurement professional." "If we lose track of one MacBook Pro, of capital that literally vanishes into
DOES (Observable Actions & Habits)	FEELS (Emotional States & Stress Dynamics)
- Maintains a shadow Excel workbook on SharePoint audit with 28 columns to track order progress. - Manually copies employee names, model numbers, and and shipping addresses between 3 separate apps. Teams. - Sends polite reminder messages to managers on negotiations are day 3, day 5, and day 7 of approval stagnation. clerical data. - Cross-checks the physical depot inventory by delays calling Marcus directly on his mobile phone. emails.	- Anxious and defensive whenever external season approaches. - Overwhelmed by disjointed email threads constant emergency escalation pings on - Frustrated that strategic vendor delayed because she is consumed by - Resentful of being blamed for fulfillment caused by line managers ignoring approval
PAINS (Frustrations, Obstacles & System Friction) Relief)	GAINS (Aspirations, Target Outcomes &
- Complete absence of an immutable approval log that in ServiceNow, creating severe SOX audit risk. logs. - Swivel-chair data entry causing transcription spreadsheet in errors in model specs and shipping destinations - Ghost assets in alm_hardware caused by completion technicians forgetting to record asset tags. - Constant barrage of status inquiry calls from days to impatient employees and hiring managers. actions.	- A single, automated Flow Designer process routes approvals and captures immutable - Elimination of the shadow Excel favor of real-time ServiceNow reporting. - Automatic gating that prevents task without a verified barcode scan. - Slashing manager approval time from 4.8 under 8 hours via 1-click mobile email

3. Persona 2: End-User Employee / Requester — David Chen

PERSONA PROFILE: DAVID CHEN	
Professional Role	Senior Full-Stack Software Engineer (New Hire / Refresh Candidate)
Department	Cloud Platform & Core Infrastructure Engineering
Demographics	Age 31, 8 years software engineering experience; Master's in Computer Science
Core Environment	macOS / Linux, Docker, Kubernetes, IntelliJ, VS Code, Git, Jira, Slack
Core Objectives	Build high-availability microservices; execute local containers; commit code
Performance KPIs	Sprint velocity, pull request merge rate, mean time to onboard, build latency

3.1. Persona Context & Behavioral Profile

David Chen is an experienced senior software engineer who has recently joined the enterprise to architect microservices for a flagship customer-facing platform. David's work requires a high-performance workstation equipped with at least 32GB of RAM and high-speed multi-core processing to run local containerized environments (Docker, Kubernetes clusters, local databases, and IDE compilation instances).

In the current legacy model, David experiences the organizational onboarding friction firsthand. He arrived on his first day of employment with eager enthusiasm, only to be handed an eight-year-old dual-core Windows loaner laptop with 8GB of RAM that crashed within thirty minutes of starting a container daemon. When David attempted to order his standardized developer workstation, he was confronted with an opaque, multi-week bureaucratic ordeal.

3.2. David's Empathy Map Canvas

EMPATHY MAP CANVAS: DAVID CHEN	
SAYS (External Communication & Direct Quotes Concerns)	THINKS (Internal Monologue & Unspoken Concerns)
• "I can order a personal laptop from Apple or Amazon and have it on my doorstep tomorrow. Why does corporate IT take three weeks?"	• "Does this company actually value my time pay me a senior engineering salary to sit two weeks waiting for basic hardware?"
• "My manager told me she approved the laptop black	• "Did my request disappear into a digital

last Monday, but the IT portal still says Open."	hole? Nobody can tell me what stage it's in."
• "This loaner laptop is so underpowered it can't	• "I hope they don't send me the standard corporate
even run our Docker compose file without freezing."	16GB laptop; I won't be able to run my dev stack."
• "Can someone please tell me if my machine has	• "Is corporate IT completely disconnected from the
shipped so I know when to be home for courier?"	daily reality of modern software development?"
DOES (Observable Actions & Habits)	FEELS (Emotional States & Stress Dynamics)
• Constantly checks the ServiceNow portal every	• Frustrated and professionally blocked during his
morning, staring at an uninformative static tag.	first month when he wants to make an impression.
• Direct-messages his hiring manager and the IT	• Embarrassed during team standup meetings when he
helpdesk channel on Slack every 48 hours.	has to report: 'Still blocked waiting on laptop'.
• Attempts to execute development workflows on a	• Disillusioned by corporate administrative friction
personal machine, creating shadow IT risks.	compared to modern consumer digital experiences.
• Asks teammates if anyone has a spare developer	• Anxious that his probation milestones and sprint
machine he can borrow temporarily.	commitments will slip through no fault of his own.
PAINS (Frustrations, Obstacles & System Friction)	GAINS (Aspirations, Target Outcomes & Relief)
• 14.2-day fulfillment cycle time stalling	• A modern, intuitive Service Catalog item with
sprint productivity and onboarding velocity.	clearly defined developer hardware bundles.
• Zero status visibility between submission and	• Real-time, 5-stage graphical progress tracking
physical delivery (the 'black hole' effect).	visible directly on the Employee Center (/esc).
• Risk of receiving the wrong hardware model due	• Guaranteed laptop delivery within 72 hours of
to unvalidated free-text form entries.	manager signoff (<3 business days).
• Wasting hours attending IT service desk queues	• Automated SMS/Email shipping notifications with
seeking routine tracking updates.	courier tracking numbers for home delivery.

4. Persona 3: Hardware Configuration Engineer — Marcus Vance

PERSONA PROFILE: MARCUS VANCE	
Professional Role	Lead Desktop Support & Hardware Staging Technician
Department	IT Desktop Support & Depot Staging Logistics
Demographics	Age 28, 5 years desktop engineering & endpoint imaging; CompTIA A+, Jamf Pro
Core Environment	ServiceNow Task Queues, MDT / SCCM, Jamf Pro, Barcode Scanners, Depot Lab
Core Objectives	High-quality OS deployments, zero staging defects, rapid hardware turnaround
Performance KPIs	Staging OLA compliance (<24h), configuration accuracy rate, depot inventory

4.1. Persona Context & Behavioral Profile

Marcus Vance is the frontline technical specialist who physically transforms boxed hardware into fully configured, secure enterprise workstations. Marcus manages the desktop staging bench, unboxes new equipment, executes network PXE boot deployments, installs required productivity and development software packages, applies asset tags, tests hardware peripherals, and coordinates dispatch via internal desk drops or external couriers.

Under the current manual workflow, Marcus and his depot colleagues are subjected to erratic, unpredictable operational spikes. They receive tickets that lack basic configuration parameters, forcing them to halt staging to contact requesters. Furthermore, Marcus is burdened by tedious manual data entry—typing 12-digit serial numbers, MAC addresses, and barcode asset tags into multiple disconnected screens, resulting in inevitable typographical errors.

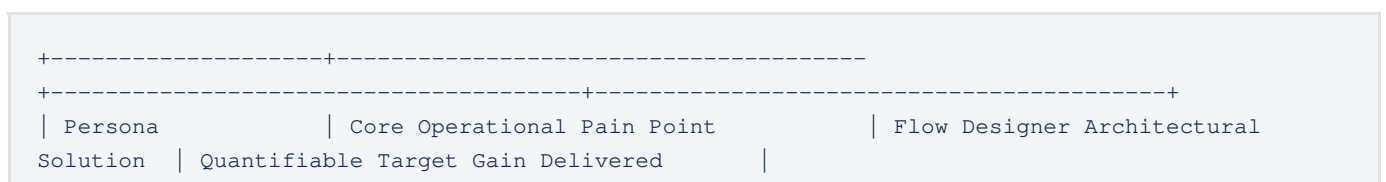
4.2. Marcus's Empathy Map Canvas

EMPATHY MAP CANVAS: MARCUS VANCE	
SAYS (External Communication & Direct Quotes) Concerns)	THINKS (Internal Monologue & Unspoken)
• "I get tickets assigned to my queue that literally say 'Prepare laptop for new hire' with no specs, no delivery site, and no target start date."	• "If tickets had complete hardware profiles and verified addresses, I could stage 25 units a day instead of fighting through 8 tickets."
• "Why do managers always dump an urgent request on us at 4:30 PM on Friday for a Monday start?"	• "I'm tired of taking the blame for delays when the ticket sat on a manager's desk for two full weeks before reaching my queue."
• "I shouldn't have to type 12-digit serial numbers into three separate screens after address ruins	• "One typo in a serial number or MAC

already scanning the physical barcode."	our CMDB and network access control for months."
• "If someone needs a developer image, tell me upstream data	• "Our team looks disorganized because
upfront so I don't build a standard Windows box."	is completely broken."
DOES (Observable Actions & Habits)	FEELS (Emotional States & Stress Dynamics)
• Halts staging to send direct emails or chat unpredictable,	• Constantly rushed and stressed by
pings to hiring managers seeking missing info.	last-minute emergency fulfillment
requests.	
• Writes asset tags and serial numbers on paper data	• Frustrated by repetitive, clerical manual
clipboards taped to laptops during imaging.	entry that could easily be automated.
• Performs batch data entry at the end of the frustration	• Demoralized when end-users express
week, manually updating alm_hardware records.	upon delivery, assuming the depot caused
delays.	
• Manually searches warehouse shelves to confirm craftsmanship	• Defensive of his team's staging
whether requested models are physically in stock.	when tickets lack clear operational
specifications.	
PAINS (Frustrations, Obstacles & System Friction)	GAINS (Aspirations, Target Outcomes & Relief)
• Incomplete, ambiguous sc_task records lacking containing	• Automatically generated sc_task records
crucial software bundle and delivery variables.	pre-validated model, RAM, OS, and site
data.	
• Fire-drill requests caused by upstream approval	• Predictable, leveled staging queues with
a strict	
delays, leading to stressful emergency rushes.	24-hour staging OLA and clear
prioritization.	
• Manual transcription errors during serial and directly in	• Enforced barcode scanning validation
asset tag entry creating inventory drift.	the task UI, automatically updating
alm_hardware.	
• Lack of clear SLA boundaries, resulting in the notification	• Instant closure of upstream RITM and
staging team being blamed for entire 14-day wait.	dispatch upon marking the sc_task Closed
Complete.	

5. Cross-Persona Comparative Synthesis & Intersecting Failure Points

A critical insight revealed by the Empathy Map Canvas study is that the three personas do not operate in isolation; rather, **friction experienced by one persona compounds and cascades into the next persona's workflow**, creating an enterprise-wide cycle of operational degradation.



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| **Sarah Jenkins** | Chasing managers via email; unlinked | Flow Designer Action: *Ask for
| Approval time cut from 4.8 days to |
| (Procurement Lead) | approvals; SOX audit non-compliance | Approval* with 1-click mobile
email | < 8 hours; 100% immutable audit log in |
| | and Excel spreadsheet tracking. | and automated 24h reminders.
| sys_flow_context and sysapproval_approver. |
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| **David Chen** | 14.2-day cycle time; zero status | Standard Catalog Item with
dynamic | Turnaround reduced to < 3 business days; |
| (Sr. Developer / | visibility; receiving wrong hardware | variable bundles; real-time 5-
stage | 100% real-time stage tracking on portal; |
| Requester) | specs; blocked sprint productivity. | visual tracking bar on Employee
Center| zero spec errors; Day 1 readiness. |
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| **Marcus Vance** | Ambiguous tickets; 4:30 PM emergency | Action: *Create Catalog Task*
with | Fully populated sc_task with pre-bound |
| (Desktop Support / | rushes; manual serial/tag re-keying; | data pills binding RITM
variables; | specs; 24h staging OLA; mandatory barcode|
| Staging Tech) | unlinked ghost assets in inventory. | mandatory barcode validation on
close.| validation updating alm_hardware in-place. |
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6.1. Architectural Realization for Sarah Jenkins

- **Automated Governance:** The flow automatically looks up `trigger.current.opened_by.manager` and instantiates a formal record in `sysapproval_approver`. If the manager does not respond within 24 business hours, an automated reminder is dispatched. If unapproved at 48 hours, it escalates to the Department Head.
- **Audit Elimination:** Zero need to archive Outlook emails; every approval decision, timestamp, and comment is permanently bonded to the RITM execution record.

6.2. Architectural Realization for David Chen

- **Service Portal Transparency:** As Flow Designer executes, it transitions `sc_req_item.stage` across `waiting_for_approval`, `fulfillment`, `delivery`, and `complete`. David views an interactive, graphical stage bar on `/esc` at any time from his desktop or mobile phone.
- **Guaranteed Developer Specifications:** Catalog UI policies enforce pre-approved developer bundles (Apple MacBook Pro 16" or Dell Precision 16" with 32GB RAM and 1TB SSD), preventing human misinterpretation.

6.3. Architectural Realization for Marcus Vance

- **Pre-Populated Context:** Flow Designer creates the `sc_task` and populates the Task Description with:

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"Stage Standard Laptop: Developer Standard (macOS) for David Chen. Delivery Site: Remote Courier
(1044 Market St, San Francisco, CA). Target Start Date: 2026-10-15."
```

- **Automated Asset Synchronization:** A ServiceNow Data Policy prevents Marcus from setting the task state to "Closed Complete" unless the `u_asset_tag` field contains a valid record from `alm_hardware`. Once saved, Flow Designer automatically updates the asset status from "In Stock" to "In Use" and assigns ownership to David Chen with zero manual re-typing.